

of your own money, there is less reason to be scared. Remember the two things that stop most people from starting a business—the belief that it takes a lot of money and a lack of confidence. If you can start a business for little or no money, you’ve killed both birds with one stone.

Donegan stresses doing whatever you can to start your business with no start-up costs. He noted multiple ways to do this, including finding ways to get as much as possible for free through available resources, borrowing things for little or no cost, and bartering instead of spending money. He also advises selling your value before you create it, noting that if you can build trust, you can ask for payment before creating and delivering your product or service. He said it’s possible to build any type of business while starting with nothing. “I’ve seen restaurants built for free. I’ve seen physical businesses built with bricks and mortar built for free. I’ve seen websites and online businesses built for free. In fact, I haven’t found a single business yet that you can’t start for free.”

Side Hustles and Encore Careers

For some, going all in on a business still feels risky. This is where many in the FI community incorporate a side hustle. A side hustle is